



PROGRESS REPORT

Somalia: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 58 systems and instruments tracked

Of 58 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 33 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 9 did not, 6 carry no stated baseline, and 10 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 71 sources for this place in the window — 27 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 44 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

In the twelve months to 9 August 2026 Somalia built more of its digital state than in any comparable period the base covers: a mass identity registration drive, a cybersecurity law and an incident response team, a data-protection regulator that began enforcing, a national payment rail extended toward the wallets that carry most transactions, and a first service-delivery layer of job, health and revenue platforms. Almost all of it is new construction rather than movement in an existing position, which is why 29 of 48 rows changed and only 7 held still. What did not move is the part that decides whether the rest works: no interoperability standard was published, no member state changed its position on the federal identity credential, and the National Data Centre remains where it was in May 2025.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Transformation Strategy 2025-2030	A strategy in drafting with no finalisation process on record (2025-08)	Finalisation under way with ITU support; no adopted text, costing or delivery schedule published (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity Law	Did not exist; a cybercrime bill of August 2025 was the only instrument on record (2025-08)	In force, assigning policy to the communications ministry, technical oversight to the regulator and obligations to critical-infrastructure operators, and creating the incident response team (2026-01)	ADVANCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Authority	Inaugurated February 2024 and issuing guidelines, with no enforcement action on record (2025-08)	Requiring all controllers and processors to register and issuing compliance certificates; no penalty issued on record (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Regulatory framework for the public data protection law	Did not exist	Adopted, operationalising the Act and aligning it to the digital transformation agenda (2026-02)	ADVANCED
Request to delay WhatsApp usernames	Did not exist	Request outstanding with no platform response on record; Somalia is the second country after India to ask for a pause (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act (Law 005/2023)	In force, with lawful bases, data-subject rights and fines of 2-4% of worldwide turnover (2025-08)	In force and unamended; the Act does not define public data, which clouds the regulator's mandate (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Accession to the African Continental Free Trade Area	Did not exist	Somalia is to become the 50th state party on depositing its instrument of ratification in September 2026, having agreed with the Secretariat at Mogadishu on 18 August 2026 a sequence running from ratification through domesticating the electronic tariff book and configuring preferential tariffs in the customs administration to completing outstanding East African Community tariff and services commitments and a first shipment, with the continental payment system and the AfCFTA Adjustment Fund named as the instruments available and the national chamber of commerce asking for access to services markets including telecommunications, logistics, finance and digital commerce	ADVANCED
Connection to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System	Did not exist	A stated target for before end-2026 rather than a concluded arrangement (2026-07)	ADVANCED

This is the section that moved most, and it moved by adoption rather than by enforcement. The data-protection framework went from an Act with guidelines to [an adopted regulatory framework in February 2026](#) and a regulator taking its [first nationwide enforcement step in June 2026](#); no penalty has followed. The [Cybersecurity Law was approved in January 2026](#), where a year earlier only a bill existed.

The [national digital strategy is still in finalisation with ITU support](#) and has no adopted text, so the instrument meant to sequence all of the above is the one thing that has not been issued.

Two outward-facing positions were created inside the window and neither has an answer yet: the [request to Meta to delay WhatsApp usernames](#) and the [stated target of connecting to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System before end-2026](#).

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project, Somalia component	Approved 2023-05-18; implementation progress rated Unsatisfactory	US\$162m IDA across the project after a US\$10m partial cancellation in Somalia in April 2026; implementation progress raised to Moderately Unsatisfactory and overall risk from High to Substantial, with fiduciary and environmental-and-social risk both still High (2026-06-16)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
World Bank financing for the digital identity rollout	SCALED-UP funding the identity toolset at US\$75m (2025-08)	Identity a pillar of the SPRING initiative of more than US\$100m, with about US\$125m more estimated to complete the rollout and no funding source named (2026-01)	ADVANCED

Financing for the identity rollout was restated upward: from the toolset funding held at the start of the window to **digital identity as a pillar of an initiative of more than US\$100m**, and an official estimate that **about US\$125m more is needed to complete it**, with no source named for the gap.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Starlink satellite service	Licensed in April 2025 after about two and a half years of talks, not yet available nationwide (2025-08)	Available across the country at US\$390 for hardware and US\$70 a month, US\$210 for the mini terminal, with a first local reseller from September 2025 (2025-09)	ADVANCED
Submarine cable landings and their regulatory framework	Landings at Mogadishu, Berbera and Bosaso with no submarine cable regulatory framework on record (2025-08)	Working group opened on outage management, competition and a regulatory framework; no framework published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Internet use and price	BASELINE NOT HELD	10.7m internet users, more than half the population; median fixed download 18.76 Mbps, up 67% year on year; mobile data about US\$0.50 per GB (2025-10)	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Government data-hosting and cloud guidelines	None published	None published (2026-06-16)	NO CHANGE
Hormuud data centre estate	11 data centres of about 10 MWh, the working private hosting base (2024-12)	Further domestic capacity stated as under investment; no updated site count or load figure published (2026-06)	NO CHANGE
National Data Centre, Mogadishu	Under construction and described as nearing completion, not launched (2025-05)	No launch recorded in the base; on 7 August 2026 the state minister for communications described a National Data Centre as being planned to strengthen digital infrastructure, speaking at the launch of an artificial-intelligence product by a private centre	NO CHANGE

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National IPv6 migration	Strategy adopted February 2025, with no migration activity on record (2025-08)	Migration running with a National IPv6 Centre at Jamhuriya University; no adoption percentage published (2026-06)	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Cybersecurity Risk Management Framework	Did not exist	Launched covering risk identification, regulatory compliance and institutional responsibilities; no compliance deadline or reporting duty published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Somalia Computer Incident Response Team (SOMCIRT)	Did not exist; provided for in the Cybersecurity Law (2025-08)	Operating to coordinate prevention, detection and response, with 45 officials in first-phase training (2026-03)	ADVANCED

Satellite connectivity crossed from licensed to universal inside the window: Starlink went from [a licence granted in April 2025 to nationwide availability by August](#), at prices that put it beyond most households, with a [first local reseller from September 2025](#). Internet use was recorded at [10.7m people in October 2025](#), the base's only measurement in the period.

The submarine cables underneath went from unregulated to [under a first technical working group with the IFC in June 2026](#), with the framework itself still unpublished, and [IPv6 migration moved from a February 2025 strategy to an active programme](#).

The cyber layer was built from almost nothing. At the start of the period the only instrument on record was a cybercrime bill; by the end there was [a law, an incident response team with 45 officials trained and a national risk management framework](#).

One position did not move at all. The [National Data Centre was described as nearing completion in May 2025](#) and no launch has been recorded in the fifteen months since, leaving state hosting where it was.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Interoperability between government systems	No national coordination forum on record (2025-08)	First national DPI summit held in February 2026 with the Central Bank, the regulator, the identity authority and the data protection authority; no interoperability standard or role-clarity instrument published (2026-04)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Revenue and financial-management systems integrated with SFMIS	Not held	Seven government revenue and financial-management systems are not integrated with the state financial management information system, on the Auditor-General's 2025 annual audit; the same audit records 66 legal-compliance breaches across 22 audited bodies covering 60.1% of the national budget, including US\$18.5m of contracts awarded without following committee procedures, and finds a port and airport revenue-share operator's reporting of US\$38.08m of a combined US\$42.24m could not be verified	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Compulsory use of the national identity credential	Required for bank accounts from 29 July 2025, with a passport requirement due from 1 September (2025-08)	Required for passports, bank accounts, driving licences, vehicle registration and domestic travel, and enforced for inter-state travel (2026-03)	ADVANCED, CONTESTED
eAqoonsi mobile identity application	Launched alongside the HUBIYE verification platform and the certificate delivery system, all built in-house (2025-05)	More than 50,000 downloads against about 2m registrations, with digital activation still requiring an in-person visit (2026-04)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
National passport	10m passports in circulation with no record of how many were lawfully issued (2025-09)	Cleared in February 2026 to adopt and print the East African Community e-passport, and a third-generation plan approved by Cabinet; no issuance date published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Somali National Identity credential (SNID)	Issued since September 2023 from a near-zero base, with mass registration not yet launched (2025-08)	About 2m registered against a target of 15m by the end of 2029, with more than 24 services integrated (2026-04)	ADVANCED
HUBIYE consent-based verification platform	In service as the verification layer for the national identity credential (2025-08)	In service; no verification volume or integrated-institution count published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Member state participation in the national identity system	Puntland and Jubbaland declining to implement the federal credential (2025-08)	Position unchanged, with Puntland running a separate authority and citing data control, election influence and regional autonomy (2025-09)	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
EVC Plus mobile money	Operating as the dominant private rail, uncertified in the current cycle (2025-08)	Re-certified against about 300 criteria, one of about ten platforms worldwide to hold it, serving 4.5m daily users and used by more than 145 aid organisations (2025-08)	ADVANCED
Somalia Instant Payment System (SIPS)	Live since January 2025 with seven institutions, operated on a commercial switching platform (2025-08)	Carrying person-to-person, merchant, government-to-person and person-to-government flows on ISO 20022, targeting 14 commercial banks and eight mobile money and e-wallet providers; mobile money integration has no published date (2026-07)	ADVANCED
SOMQR national QR payment standard	Launched alongside the instant payment system to reach traders without dedicated hardware (2025-08)	In service and linked to the instant payment system; no merchant count or transaction figure published (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Unified digital civil registration system	Registration and vital statistics system handed over by NADRA in November 2024, with no district pilot running (2025-08)	Piloted across 19 districts on an open-source platform as the vital-events layer beneath legal identity; no registration coverage figure published (2026-01)	ADVANCED

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Electronic Immunization Register	Did not exist	Running on an open-source health platform, assigning each vaccinated child a unique identifier with dose histories and SMS reminders, against about 60% of children recorded as zero-dose (2026-02)	ADVANCED
Pandemic Fund health information project	Did not exist	A project to strengthen prevention, preparedness, detection and response for infectious disease and public health emergencies, launched by the health minister with a set of multilateral and regional partners	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Federal electronic visa	Did not exist	In force, with the federal government negotiating to exempt residents of one region from the fee while keeping the entry system itself in place, as part of wider federal talks	ADVANCED
National job portal	Ministries recruiting separately through notices, radio and messaging groups (2025-08)	One centralised platform for public vacancies, hosted domestically; no vacancy or placement figure published (2026-02)	ADVANCED
Digital voter registration	Equipment unveiled, with no registration exercise reported (2025-08)	No registration figure, timetable or relationship to the national identity credential published since (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
National Single Window	BASELINE NOT HELD	Planned, with no design, timetable or budget published; named alongside a Trade Information Portal and the existing SOMCAS and SOMLITS systems it is to connect to	Baseline not held

Identity registration roughly doubled and then some: from the position before the mass drive to [about 2m registered by April 2026, with more than 24 services integrated](#), against a target of 15m by the end of 2029. The mandates around it widened from bank accounts and passports to [driving licences, vehicle registration and inter-state travel](#). The digital credential moved much less: [more than 50,000 downloads](#) against about 2m registrations, with activation still requiring an in-person visit.

Two positions around the credential are the same at both ends of the window. [Puntland and Jubbaland still decline the federal system](#), and the legal basis for compulsory use remains contested between the September 2025 proclamation and [a published analysis holding that the Act confers a right and imposes no duty](#).

Payments advanced at the rail and not yet at the wallet. The instant payment system went from seven institutions to [a published sequence reaching 14 banks and eight wallet providers, with mobile money integration undated](#); the private rail it must reach was [GSMA re-certified in August 2025](#).

Three service platforms existed at the end of the period and none at the start: [a national job portal](#), [an immunization register in 14 facilities](#), and [state-level revenue terminals in Hirshabelle](#). What connects them did not advance: the country held its first DPI summit in February 2026, and a domestic analysis of April 2026 still finds [fragmentation and weak coordination as the central risk](#), with no interoperability standard published.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
SUMER revenue collection terminals (Hirshabelle)	Paper vouchers carried up to 90km and hand-keyed, on a reconciliation cycle of 30 to 45 days (2025-08)	Terminals holding the tariff schedule on the device, paying over mobile money into the government account with real-time QR receipts (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Somali National University AI Centre	Did not exist	Established for research and digital skills; no funding, staffing or research output stated (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Garad.ai	Not held	Launched by a private artificial-intelligence centre alongside the communications and technology ministry; the state minister for communications used the launch to set out the ministry's wider technology-sector policy push and to say a National Data Centre is planned	BASELINE NOT HELD
National AI readiness assessment	Not held	Under way, led by the communications and technology ministry with UNESCO, examining artificial-intelligence policy, data governance and higher-education capacity for artificial intelligence; a private university joined the exercise on 17 August 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National e-commerce strategy	None published	None published (2026-06-16)	NO CHANGE

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National startup network	Did not exist	Connecting startups to incubators, chambers of commerce and agencies, on European Union funding implemented by UNIDO; the project reports 3,600 applications across three cohorts and more than 200 startups incubated (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Regulator partnership with iRise Hub	Did not exist	Memorandum covering innovation, skills, cybersecurity and research with no figure, term, named deliverable or funder (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Every row in this section was created within the window and none of them is a state instrument. A [university AI centre](#), a [donor-funded national startup network](#) and a [regulator memorandum with a private hub](#) all appeared in July 2026. No national artificial intelligence policy exists at either end of the period.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Certified cybersecurity training for government ICT staff	Did not exist	Delivered by the regulator with World Bank SCALED-UP funding and AFRALTI, covering incident response, cloud security and auditing; no participant total published (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Fixed asset management training (Somaliland administration)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Training run to support fixed-asset recording in public financial management; no participant total, system or completion date stated (2026-08)	Baseline not held

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
University research partnership on official microdata	Did not exist	A pilot training researchers from three universities on the statistics bureau's household budget and labour force microdata, funded by the Swiss development agency with no amount stated (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Smartphone financing programme	Did not exist	Targeting 100,000 affordable smartphones by end-2026 at a US\$19 deposit and US\$0.60 to US\$1.60 a day, repaid over mobile money and scored on SIM tenure and spend; a pilot recorded under 4% default (2026-05)	ADVANCED

Access work shifted from the network to the device: a [smartphone financing programme launched in May 2026 targeting 100,000 handsets by the end of the year](#). Capacity work started where none was recorded before, with [certified cybersecurity training for government ICT staff](#) and a [pilot opening official microdata to domestic researchers](#), both externally funded.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National artificial intelligence policy	An adopted or draft national AI strategy, a ministerial mandate, or a government statement setting an AI position.	not yet probed
Earth observation or geospatial data programme	A national geospatial or earth-observation programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	not yet probed
Rural digital data capture	A pastoralist, agricultural or rural registry, or a field data-collection programme covering rural populations.	not yet probed
Public debate on digital policy	Published civil-society analysis, a parliamentary debate record, or a consultation response on a digital instrument.	not yet probed
Open government data	An open-data portal, a published dataset release policy, or an agency statement on publishing government data.	not yet probed
Digital literacy programmes	A national digital literacy curriculum, campaign or programme document.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	The federal appropriation act or budget statement showing the votes for the communications ministry, the regulator and the identity authority.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
European Union digital cooperation with Somalia	A Global Gateway or EU delegation announcement, a financing agreement, or a programme document naming Somalia beyond the innovation project already held.	not yet probed
Chinese digital cooperation with Somalia	A bilateral agreement, vendor contract or financing arrangement naming Somalia.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with Somalia	A bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit agreement, or an India Stack or ITEC programme document naming Somalia.	not yet probed

Ten rows carry no position at either end: nine subjects the base holds nothing on for Somalia, and a national artificial intelligence policy the base does not show to exist. None was probed within this period; each is carried into the next. Where the national identity data is physically held is a disagreement rather than an absence, and remains open in the wiki's contradictions queue.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.